Capgemini Global Employee Leave & Absence Policy

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1. Objective and Intent

Capgemini is committed to fostering a healthy work-life balance and recognizes the importance of time away from work for personal well-being, family obligations, and professional development. This policy serves as a comprehensive guide to the various leave entitlements, eligibility criteria, and administrative procedures for all employees. It aims to ensure consistency, transparency, and fairness across the organization.

2. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all permanent, full-time, and part-time employees of Capgemini and its subsidiaries.

- **Full-time Employees:** Entitled to full benefits as outlined.
- **Part-time Employees:** Entitlements are pro-rated based on their contracted hours relative to a standard 40-hour work week.
- **Contractors/Temporary Staff:** Leave entitlements for third-party contractors are governed by their respective agencies.
- **Regional Variations:** Where local law provides greater benefits, the local standard applies.

3. Definitions

- **Calendar Year:** The period from January 1st to December 31st.
- **Pro-rata:** Calculation of leave based on the portion of the year worked.
- **Core Hours:** The standard hours during which business operations are conducted (typically 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM).
- **Immediate Family:** Includes spouse, domestic partner, children, parents, siblings, grandparents, and legal guardians.
- **Service Year:** The 12-month period beginning on the employee's date of join.

4. Public and Statutory Holidays

4.1 Global Holiday Framework

Capgemini observes a mix of national and regional public holidays. The official holiday calendar is published via the HR portal by December 1st for the following year.

4.2 Floating Holidays

In addition to fixed public holidays, employees are granted two (2) "Floating Holidays" per year. These may be used for religious, cultural, or personal significance.

- **Requesting:** Floating holidays must be requested 30 days in advance.
- **Lapse:** Floating holidays do not carry forward and cannot be encashed.
- **Blackout Exceptions:** Floating holidays are permitted during blackout windows if business coverage is secured.

5. Annual Leave (Privilege Leave)

5.1 Accrual Methodology

- **Standard Entitlement:** 25 working days per calendar year.
- **Accrual Rate:** 2.08 days per month of completed service.
- **Vesting:** Leave is available for use as it is accrued. New hires may utilize "Advanced Leave" up to 5 days with manager approval during their first 90 days.
- **Part-Time Accrual:** Pro-rated based on contracted hours and calculated monthly.

5.2 Carry Forward and Limits

- **Maximum Carry Forward:** 15 days into the next calendar year.
- **Mandatory Usage:** To prevent burnout, employees are strongly encouraged to take at least 10 consecutive days of leave once a year.
- **Blackout Dates:** Certain departments (e.g., Financial Services, Year-End Support) may have blackout dates where leave is restricted. These will be communicated 90 days in advance.
- **Year-End Forfeiture:** Days above the carry forward cap are forfeited unless a written exception is approved by HR.

5.3 Leave Encashment

Capgemini does not permit leave encashment during active employment to encourage rest. Encashment is only processed upon separation, capped at 30 days of accumulated leave.

6. Sick and Health-Related Leave

6.1 Short-Term Sick Leave

- **Entitlement:** 12 days per year for minor illnesses.
- **Notification:** Employees must notify their manager via email or SMS by 9:30 AM on the first day of absence.
- **Medical Evidence:** A doctor’s note is required for absences exceeding three (3) consecutive days.
- **Telehealth:** Telehealth notes are accepted when in-person care is not feasible.

6.2 Long-Term Disability and Medical Leave

For illnesses lasting longer than 15 days, employees may transition to Short-Term Disability (STD) as defined in the Benefits Guide. HR will initiate a "Return to Work" assessment for absences exceeding 30 days.

- **Work Restrictions:** Temporary work accommodations may be provided based on medical advice.

7. Parental and Family Leave

7.1 Maternity Leave

- **Duration:** 26 weeks of paid leave.
- **Eligibility:** Minimum of 6 months of continuous service.
- **Phased Return:** New mothers may request a 4-day work week for the first 4 weeks back at full pay to ease the transition.

7.2 Paternity and Secondary Caregiver Leave

- **Duration:** 4 weeks of paid leave.
- **Flexibility:** Can be taken in a single block or two blocks within the first year of the child's birth/adoption.

7.3 Adoption and Surrogacy Leave

Aligned with Maternity/Paternity leave durations based on the employee's role as primary or secondary caregiver.

7.4 Family Care Leave

Employees may take up to 10 days per year to care for an immediate family member with a serious health condition. Documentation may be requested.

8. Specialty Leave Categories

8.1 Marriage Leave

Employees are granted five (5) days of one-time paid leave for their own marriage. This must be used within 30 days of the wedding event.

8.2 Bereavement Leave

- **Immediate Family:** 5 days.
- **Extended Family/Close Friends:** 1 day.
- **Travel Extension:** An additional 2 days may be granted if international travel is required.

8.3 Sabbatical Leave

- **Eligibility:** After five (5) years of continuous service.
- **Duration:** 1 to 3 months, unpaid.
- **Purpose:** Personal growth, travel, or volunteer work. Job role is guaranteed upon return.

8.4 Study and Exam Leave

Up to 3 days per year for preparing for and attending professional certification exams relevant to the employee’s career path.

8.5 Jury Duty and Public Service

Employees will be granted paid leave for jury duty or required public service obligations. Any court stipend must be reported to payroll.

8.6 Military Leave

Capgemini supports employees who serve in the armed forces. Military leave is provided in accordance with local law and re-employment protections.

9. Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)

9.1 Eligibility

Applicable to employees at Level C and below who are required to work on a weekend or public holiday due to critical project delivery.

9.2 Validity

- Must be used within 60 days of the date earned.
- Cannot be accumulated beyond 5 days.
- Requires prior manager approval and project code for recordkeeping.

10. Leave Without Pay (LWOP)

LWOP is granted only in exceptional circumstances (e.g., family emergencies or extended illness) after all other leave balances are exhausted. LWOP exceeding 10 days will result in a pro-rata adjustment of the annual bonus and performance cycles.

- **Benefits Impact:** Certain benefits may be suspended if LWOP exceeds 30 days, subject to local law.

11. Leave Donation Program

Employees may donate up to 3 days of their Annual Leave balance to a "Global Leave Bank" to support colleagues facing catastrophic medical emergencies. Donations are anonymous and voluntary.

- **Eligibility to Receive:** Employees must provide documentation verified by HR.

12. Impact of Leave on Performance and Pay

- **Performance Reviews:** Leave taken under statutory rights (Maternity, FMLA) will not negatively impact performance ratings.
- **Bonus Calculation:** Pro-rated only in cases of LWOP or Sabbaticals.
- **Promotion Cycles:** Approved leave does not delay eligibility for promotion consideration.

13. Application and Approval Workflow

1. **Request:** Submit via the "MyConnect" HR Portal.
2. **Manager Review:** Managers must approve/reject within 48 hours.
3. **Conflict Resolution:** If multiple team members request the same dates, seniority and previous holiday history will be considered.

4. **Cancellation:** Approved leave can be cancelled by the employee up to 24 hours before the start date.
5. **Escalation:** If no action is taken within 5 business days, requests auto-escalate to HR.

14. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q: Can I take half-day leave?
A: Yes, Annual and Sick leave can be applied for in half-day increments.

Q: What happens if I fall sick during my Annual Leave?
A: If you provide a medical certificate, the portion of your Annual Leave can be converted to Sick Leave.

Q: Is there a limit to how many people can be on leave in one team?
A: Typically, a 20% team absence threshold is maintained to ensure business continuity.

15. Compliance and Governance

Failure to adhere to the notification or documentation requirements may result in the absence being marked as "Unauthorized," leading to Loss of Pay and potential disciplinary action. Repeated abuse of leave policies may result in progressive disciplinary measures.

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